

insights for better decision-making and, sometimes, even automate the decision-making process itself.

Industries are opening up to the concept of predictive analysis for future decision-making, but this is yet to accelerate. Accenture's Business Futures 2021 report says 78 per cent of organisations in India have increased their use of both internal and external sources of real-time data over the past 12 months, yet only 43 per cent reported that people across their organisation consistently use real-time data in their day-to-day work.

Piyush N. Singh, Senior MD and Lead of India Market Unit at Accenture, says there are no specific industries that are racing ahead or lagging behind in digital transformation. "The reality is, in every industry, companies can be bucketed under three categories—leaders that are taking transformation seriously and are therefore investing holistically in the entire value chain; laggards that are only investing in parts of the value chain; and companies that are barely investing in digital transformation." The leaders are still a minority—not more than 20 per cent in any industry—and they will surge ahead, he says.

BY 2025, 180 zettabytes of data are expected to be created. Just how much is that? You are aware of a TB or terabyte—most PC hard drives have a capacity of 1TB or 2TB. Now, one zettabyte is one billion TB. Try and wrap your head around what 180ZB of data means.

This data explosion, albeit a bit scary, also presents enormous opportunities for businesses. Fuelled by this data, smarter organisations are infusing AI and the agility of the hybrid cloud to better predict and shape future outcomes and automate decisions. "By leveraging data as a strategic enterprise asset, companies can accelerate or scale digital transformation, and also contribute to high revenues and business growth," says Kamal Singhani, Country Managing Partner for India/South Asia at IBM Consulting.



"Process can be bucketed under five areas: optimising the sources of data, efficiently storing the data, cleaning the data, sorting the data using analytical records or models to generate insights, and consuming the insights for data-driven decision-making"

PIYUSH N. SINGH
SENIOR MD & LEAD-INDIA
MARKET UNIT,
ACCENTURE



"Data-driven transformations drive digital transformations and hence the overall cost is typically part of the transformation itself"

SOM SATSANGI
SVP AND MD,
HEWLETT PACKARD
ENTERPRISE, INDIA

With digital transformation riding on data analysis, an enterprise can re-engineer, automate and infuse intelligence across key business functions. According to *Harvard Business Review*, such data-driven transformation can yield 54 per cent increase in revenue performance, 44 per cent faster time-to-market, and 62 per cent improvement in customer satisfaction.

Tight integration of data also highlights the organisation's competencies and presents unlimited business opportunities. Satyakam Mohanty, Chief Product Officer of Fosfor by LTI (L&T Infotech), explains: "Insights derived from real-world data will allow you an (enterprise) to look farther into the future than you (normally) could. Instead of relying on day-by-day snapshots of your business, you'll be able to set solid, measurable goals several years into the future."

For example, Parle, India's largest biscuit company, leveraged IBM's hybrid cloud and AI capabilities, to get its products to market at the right time and in the right place. Sanjay Joshi, Head of Information Technology of Parle Products, says that the recent market dynamics "has necessitated the need to accelerate the innovation with digital platforms, drive resiliency in our supply chain, and augment decision support systems with AI".

Apart from legacy enterprises, start-ups are also building their business models around data. B2B e-commerce platform Udaan is emerging as a preferred trade partner of established brands such as Apple and Samsung not just because of its reach in Tier II, III and IV towns, but also from the data insights it brings to the table—what options your customers considered, why were they considered, and which choices were made. How does this help? "The industry is able to identify and plan for SKU and brand preferences by region over lean and peak periods. Digitisation has also helped create predictive analysis on promotion planning," says Hirendrakumar Rathod, Head of the Electronics Category at Udaan.